

Response to [Request for Information](#): Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

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Submitted to: Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) and NITRD National Coordination Office.

Submitted by: SecureBio, Inc.

SecureBio is a nonprofit organization conducting technical research and developing tools to promote safe biotechnological innovation, composed of biologists, machine learning engineers, and software developers. Our AIxBio team focuses on AI capabilities research and evaluations. We collaborate with government agencies and most of the major LLM developers, providing expertise on measuring AI capabilities.

SecureBio is available to brief stakeholders on AI capabilities in biology, including our non-public evaluations showing that AIs have begun to reach expert-level and beyond.

Summary

Part 1: USG should have an entity that is the **world leader in the measurement of AI model capabilities**.

- Understanding the capabilities, limitations, and risks of newly produced leading-edge models helps policymakers understand the potential of the technology. This will enable USG to have access to the **best possible intelligence** on the rapidly changing landscape of what AIs can do now and in the future.
- Therefore, dedicating resources to understanding AI capabilities is crucial for the United States to remain at the cutting edge of AI development and will help realize a vast array of benefits in tech, medicine, manufacturing, finance, and other domains.
- US AISI in NIST is already making very strong contributions on this front, and we recommend that they be strengthened to continue that work.

Part 2: Prepare for a near future in which AI has caused a proliferation of **bioweapon-relevant expertise**.

- SecureBio has shown that leading AIs can provide practical assistance on tasks that can enable bioweapon development. Leading models now outperform PhD researchers in several such areas.
- This capability transfer is substantially reducing the expertise barrier that has historically prevented malicious actors from acquiring and deploying biological weapons.
- Given evidence that certain AI systems pose national security risks, testing and evaluation mandates for frontier models are essential to mitigate such risks.
- Near-future AI models will be even more capable, and would enable malicious actors to develop augmented and novel bioweapons.
- USG should immediately create guidelines to address these capabilities, invest in biosurveillance, and improve our resilience to possible bioweapon attacks.

Part 1: USG should have an entity that is the world leader in measuring AI capabilities.

The pace of AI progress continues to accelerate, and capabilities are expanding across domains from reasoning to specialized expertise. To maintain America's competitive edge, USG requires world-leading capacity to measure and understand these evolving capabilities.

Recommendations

1. **Empower US AISI to continue work in this domain**
 - Provide sufficient funding and computing resources for regular evaluation of frontier models.
 - Staff the office with top technical talent through competitive compensation packages.
 - If AISI is restructured, the successor entity should have an enshrined statutory remit of being a world leader in evaluating AI systems.
2. **Direct US AISI to create recommended standards and best-practices for evaluation**
 - Work with AI labs, non-profits, and academic researchers to create standards for structuring and running AI evaluations.
 - Prioritize evaluation of pre-release frontier models, through collaboration with leading AI developers.
 - Develop secure protocols for evaluating proprietary systems while protecting intellectual property.

Expected benefits

1. **Intelligence advantage:** Provide U.S. decision-makers with high-quality data and insights into the global AI landscape, creating a critical intelligence advantage in monitoring both domestic and foreign AI development.
2. **Economic leadership:** Enable targeted investment in areas where U.S. capabilities require strengthening, ensuring continued American leadership in AI innovation.
3. **Safety assurance:** Identify potentially harmful capabilities before deployment, allowing for proactive development of appropriate safeguards and regulations.
4. **National security:** Maintain awareness of dual-use capabilities that may present national security risks if leveraged by adversaries.

Part 2: Prepare for a near future in which AI has caused a proliferation of bioweapon-relevant expertise

Our research team has conducted extensive evaluation of how current AI systems can transfer expertise in virology and other dual-use research. The findings indicate that **leading AI models now exceed the capabilities of human experts in providing practical guidance in bioweapon-relevant work**. This is substantially reducing the expertise barrier that has historically prevented malicious actors from acquiring and deploying biological weapons. Near-future AI models will demonstrate even greater capabilities, enabling the development of novel or augmented bioweapons by actors who previously lacked the necessary expertise. We expect such capabilities to arrive in 2026 or 2027.

Recommendations

1. **Evaluations conducted by USG should identify models with strong bio-capabilities**
 - Some of these evaluations can include sensitive information.
2. **Establish biosecurity-focused AI governance for high-priority models**
 - Develop specialized guidelines for AI systems that provide dual-use biological expertise.
 - Create clear standards for when companies must implement additional safeguards on models with bioweapon-relevant capabilities.
3. **Classify key AI capabilities as dual-use technologies**
 - Expert-level AI assistance for virology should be regulated as a dual-use technology, subject to similar controls as physical biological materials and equipment.
 - Incentivize Know-Your-Customer (KYC) verification mechanisms for AI systems capable of expert-level guidance on particularly important bioweapon-relevant methods.
4. **Enhance monitoring systems**
 - Fund development of specialized red-teaming focused on bioweapon capabilities.
 - Create secure channels for researchers to report concerning capabilities.
5. **Promote international coordination**
 - Lead development of international standards for preventing misuse of AI in biological domains.
 - Share assessment methodologies with allies while restricting sensitive details.

Conclusion

The United States stands at a critical juncture in AI development. By establishing world-leading capabilities in AI assessment while addressing emerging biological security risks, America can maintain its technological leadership position while ensuring these powerful technologies advance human flourishing rather than creating new threats. The recommendations outlined in this response should be prioritized in the AI Action Plan to support sustained American leadership in artificial intelligence innovation.

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